

section which is executed when the form is loaded. Here we initialise 'ReadINIupdate' routine to read the '.ini' configuration file and recover the setting for the user interface that was previously saved whilst exiting the application. All the default values for various combo boxes and checkboxes are initialised here. The text-to-speech volume is also initialised here. The routine 'COMAvailable' is called to check the number of serial ports available on the computer and append the list for port-selector combo box.

Form_Resize(). Here the resizing of the form and other objects on the GUI is done. Also, the form's minimum height and width are limited to prevent overlapping of the controls due to uneven shrinking of the form. The height and width of various controls like text boxes are automatically adjusted here to match the different heights and widths of the form. This enables us to utilise maximum space over the screen.

Form_Terminate(). This is called when user presses the Close button on the top-right corner of the screen. The main thing done here is to call the 'WriteINIupdate' routine to save current setting in the '.ini' file for future retrieval, and to safely close the serial port if it was opened previously.

isButton1_Click(). This is the click event routine for 'open/close serial port' button on the software. If the serial port is closed, this function will hold the 'Open' caption displayed on top of the button. Note that this same button is used to close the communication. When 'Open' is captioned on this button during the form load, the button can be used to open the selected COM port. On clicking this button, the code reads all the settings from the settings panel such as baud rate and parity and accordingly configures the 'MSCOMM32.ocx' object. The function also warns errors if user has mistyped the settings or anything else is wrong. Now the COM port selected through combo box is allocated to the object and the port is opened. The software has got its own error-handling routines

so that if any runtime error occurs during opening of the port like the COM port is not available, the software will tell the user to select a valid COM port. On successfully opening the port, the COM port selector box *combo1* and settings panel *SStab1* are disabled so that the user cannot change them during conversation, otherwise it can lead to failure of serial conversation. And the button's caption is switched to 'Close.' Since the serial port is still open in the background, to close it completely, you need to click again on the same 'Close' button. The button's caption will now change to 'Open' again.

isButton10_Click(). This is called when user presses the Exit button on the bottom-right corner of the screen. Here again, it is to call the 'WriteINIupdate' routine to save current setting in the '.ini' file for future retrieval, and to safely close the serial port if it was opened previously.

isButton3_Click(). This button's click event is used to send arbitrary data to the serial port. It asks the user to feed data via the *InputBox* and send it to the COM port.

isButton12_Click(). This button's click event is used to send data in loops at a particular time interval to the serial port. On clicking, it asks the user to feed data via the *InputBox* and then asks for the number of times (1-255 only) to send and the time interval between them (1-65,535 milliseconds only). And then it accordingly initialises the 'no', 'dur' variables and *timer2* object to do the operation.

isButton2_Click(). This is used to load default settings to all the options in the settings panel that are preprogrammed in the code.

isButton11_Click(). It resends the previously sent data to the serial port that was stored in the 'inp' variable.

msave_Click(). This is the 'Save' menu button's click event used to save the conversation to a rich text file. It is very simple to accomplish in Visual Basic 6.0. Here we use the 'SaveFile' member of the 'richtextbox' class. First when this button is pressed, a common

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